JOB DESCRIPTION

AI Research Engineer Intern

Department	Research and Development
Reports To	Lead AI Research Engineer
Location	Remote (optional co-working space in BGC)
Shift	7:00 PM – 3:00 AM
Employment Type	Full-Time

About The Attic AI

The Attic AI builds and deploys AI and machine learning solutions for clients across different industries. We handle the end-to-end lifecycle, from scoping and data pipeline design through model development, deployment, and monitoring. Our team includes data scientists, ML engineers, AI engineers, software engineers, and R&D researchers working together to deliver production-grade AI systems. We're a growing team, which means you'll have real ownership over how things are built and how we operate.

Role Overview

The AI Research Engineer Intern will support the R&D function by assisting in the research, evaluation, and prototyping of emerging AI technologies. Working alongside senior AI Research Engineers, you will help scout out new tools and techniques, run experiments, contribute to proof-of-concept builds, and document findings all aligned with The Attic AI's roadmap and client needs.

This is a learning-intensive, hands-on role. You won't be expected to lead research initiatives independently, but you will be expected to contribute meaningfully running experiments, writing results, building parts of prototypes, and developing the skills to eventually own this work. If you're curious about what's next in AI and want to learn how a real R&D function operates inside a client-facing AI company, this is the role.

Key Responsibilities

Technology Scouting & Research Support

- Help monitor the AI/ML landscape new models, papers, frameworks, and tools and summarize findings for the research team
- Assist in literature reviews and technical assessments of emerging techniques such as agentic architectures, retrieval strategies, model compression, multi-modal systems, and synthetic data methods
- Track new LLM releases, open-source model benchmarks, and provider API updates, and compile comparison notes for the team
- Maintain organized research logs and reference libraries for ongoing R&D topics

Experimentation & Evaluation Support

- Assist in running structured experiments to evaluate candidate models, techniques, and tools under the guidance of senior engineers
- Help set up and run evaluation benchmarks, measuring accuracy, hallucination rates, latency, cost, and task-specific metrics
- Collect, organize, and visualize experiment results to support feasibility analysis
- Reproduce results from research papers or open-source projects to validate claims before the team invests further

Proof-of-Concept Contributions

- Contribute to proof-of-concept implementations by building components, writing scripts, or integrating APIs as directed
- Assist in prototyping across areas such as LLM-based systems, RAG pipelines, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, and data processing
- Test and debug POC components, flagging issues and suggesting improvements
- Help prepare POC demos and handoff materials for the Engineering and Product teams

Documentation & Communication

- Write clear experiment summaries, research notes, and comparison tables for internal use
- Assist in drafting feasibility reports and POC documentation under the guidance of senior engineers
- Present findings and learnings during internal team meetings and knowledge-sharing sessions
- Ask questions, seek feedback, and communicate blockers early and clearly

Collaboration & Learning

- Work closely with AI Research Engineers, AI Engineers, ML Engineers, and Data Scientists on day-to-day tasks
- Participate in code reviews, internal presentations, and team discussions
- Proactively learn new tools, frameworks, and techniques relevant to the team's research agenda
- Contribute to a collaborative, knowledge-sharing team culture

Collaboration

- Work closely with the Engineering Manager, and Product Owner to align research priorities with The Attic AI's roadmap, client pipeline, and strategic direction
- Coordinate with AI Engineers, ML Engineers, and Data Scientists to ensure research outputs are practical and actionable for the teams that will productionize them
- Contribute to team knowledge sharing through internal presentations, research summaries, code reviews, and documentation

Qualifications

Required

- Working proficiency in Python
- Basic understanding of LLMs — what they are, how they're used, and general awareness of tools like ChatGPT, Claude, or open-source models
- Curiosity and willingness to read research papers, explore new tools, and learn quickly
- Good written and verbal communication skills — ability to document and explain what you've tried and what you've found
- Self-motivated with the ability to work independently on assigned tasks while knowing when to ask for help

Preferred

- Foundational understanding of machine learning concepts (supervised/unsupervised learning, neural networks, model evaluation)
- Familiarity with common AI/ML libraries (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn, or similar) through coursework, personal projects, or self-study
- Personal or academic projects involving LLM-based applications, RAG systems, chatbots, or AI agents
- Familiarity with prompt engineering concepts and working with LLM provider APIs (OpenAI, Anthropic, etc.)
- Exposure to Jupyter notebooks and experiment-driven workflows
- Familiarity with Git and collaborative development workflows
- Exposure to cloud platforms (AWS, GCP, or Azure) even at a basic level
- Familiarity with AI-assisted development tools such as Claude Code, Cursor, or similar
- Interest in agentic AI, retrieval-augmented generation, model fine-tuning, or multi-modal AI

What We Offer

- Real exposure to applied AI R&D in a client-facing company — not just busywork
- Mentorship from senior AI Research Engineers and the broader engineering team
- Hands-on experience with the latest AI tools, models, and frameworks
- The opportunity to contribute to research that directly influences what The Attic AI builds
- A culture that values intellectual curiosity, ownership, and learning by doing
- Fully remote work setup with optional access to a co-working space in BGC
- Potential path to a full-time role based on performance and fit

Reporting Structure

Reports to: Lead AI Research Engineer

Works closely with: Data Scientists, ML Engineers, AI Engineers, Product Owner, Director for Research & Development

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Interested? We'd love to hear from you.